Problem Discovery Map

Use this map to turn one problem you have seen firsthand into a clear, testable problem statement. Work in pencil: you will revise it as you learn more.

1. Your shortlist

Write down three problems you have noticed in the last month, one sentence each.

Score each problem from 1 to 5 on frequency, pain and how underserved it is.

Which problem scored highest? Which one do you care about most? If they differ, why?

2. Who experiences it

Describe one specific person who lives with this problem. What does their day look like?

When and where does the problem show up for them?

How often does it happen, and when was the most recent time?

3. What they do today

List at least two current workarounds or alternatives.

What does each workaround cost them in time, money or stress?

Why do these options fall short?

4. Your problem statement

Complete the sentence: [person] struggles to [do something] when [situation], because [reason].

What is the biggest thing you are still guessing about?

Name one person you could talk to this week who lives with this problem.